Employment conditions

You can claim the cost of meals and lodging (including showers) if you meet **all four** of the following conditions:

- you work for an airline, railway, bus, or trucking company, or for any other employer whose main business is transporting goods, passengers, or both
- you travel in vehicles your employer uses to transport goods or passengers
- you **regularly** have to travel away from the municipality and metropolitan area (if there is one) where your home terminal is located
- you **regularly** incur meal **and** lodging expenses while away from the municipality and metropolitan area (if there is one) where your home terminal is located. This means that you must generally be away from home overnight to do your job

For information on meal allowances and subsidized meals, see Information Circular IC73-21, Claims for Meals and Lodging Expenses of Transport Employees, and Guide T4044, Employment Expenses.

Even if you do not meet all of the above four conditions, you may still be able to claim the cost of meals and lodging you incur in the year. For example, you may be an employee whose main duty of employment is transporting goods, but your employer's main business is not transporting goods or passengers. If you meet the conditions listed under the section called "Travelling expenses" in Chapter 3 of Guide T4044, you will still qualify to use the simplified method of meal reporting (based on a per meal rate of **$17** which includes sales tax) described in Chapter 4 of the guide.
For more information about both sets of conditions, see Information Circular IC73-21.

You can also claim the cost of meals and lodging when you meet **one** of the following conditions:

- you work away from home for a railway company as a telegrapher or station agent in a relief capacity, or carrying out maintenance and repair work for the railway company
- you are a railway employee who works away from the municipality and metropolitan area (if there is one) where your home terminal is located. You also work at such a distant location that it is unreasonable for you to return daily to your home, where you support a spouse or common-law partner, or a dependant related to you

Meal and beverage expenses for long-haul truck drivers are deductible at a rate higher than the 50% permitted for other transportation employees. During eligible travel periods, meal and beverage expenses incurred are deductible at a rate of **80%**.

You are a **long-haul truck driver** if you are an employee whose main duty of employment is transporting goods by way of driving a long-haul truck, whether or not your employer's main business is transporting goods, passengers, or both.

A **long-haul truck** is a truck or tractor that is designed for hauling freight, and has a gross vehicle weight rating of more than 11,788 kg.

An **eligible travel period** is a period during which you are away from your municipality or metropolitan area (if there is one) for at least 24 hours for the purpose of driving a long-haul truck that transports goods at least 160 kilometres from the employer's establishment to which you regularly report to work.